

# CADY H. NGO

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## EDUCATION

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**B.A. in Mathematics and Economics (*with honors*), minor in Statistics** 2025  
*Grinnell College*

- Relevant Coursework: Abstract Algebra, Applied Game Theory, Applied Statistics, Biological Psychology (ELAC), Data Science (UChicago), Differential Equations, Design & Analysis of Experiments, Econometrics, Number Theory, Probability Theory, Real Analysis, Research Methods, Statistical Modeling

**Visiting Honours Student** 2024  
*University of Edinburgh*

- Relevant Coursework: Computing & Numerics, Programming & Numerical Methods for Economics

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Predoctoral Research Fellow in Social and Decision Neuroscience** 2025–Present  
*Division of the Humanities and Social Sciences, Caltech*

- PI: Colin Camerer

**Visiting Research Fellow** 2024–2025  
*Division of the Humanities and Social Sciences, Caltech*

- PI: Colin Camerer
- Conducted in-lab and virtual experiments via Caltech's SSEL and Prolific, collecting experimental stock market data and biometric data (e.g., electrodermal activity, heart rate, blood volume pulse, skin temperature) using Empatica E4s and Embraces
- Implemented machine learning models (e.g., lasso, random forests) and forecasting models based on Afrouzi et al. (2023) to predict asset bubble formation
- Pioneered project using affect-based photo databases to induce exogenous insular cortex activation and analyzed through Neurosynth

**Mentored Advanced Project** 2025  
*Department of Psychology, Grinnell College*

- Developed an original interdisciplinary framework integrating game theory, statistical learning, and music cognition to model listener expectation and musical preference in Western classical music
- Designed and analyzed normal form, sequential, and signaling games to formalize strategic interactions between melody and bass under coordination and asymmetric information
- Grounded theoretical payoffs in entropy-based measures derived from Markov models and PCA summaries of pitch transition data from Beethoven piano sonatas

**Research Fellow** 2023  
*Department of Economics, Harvard University*

- PIs: Raj Chetty and Gregory Bruch
- Employed Stata to clean, sort, and analyze census data sets, investigating the correlation between highways and declining social mobility in major American cities
- Conducted literature reviews, designed empirical models (e.g., DID, IV, RD), and produced final research paper with replication code

**Research Assistant** 2019  
*Department of Economics, East Los Angeles College*

- Executed data collection and cleaning on seaport development and labor demands in Indonesia

## WORKING PAPERS

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Toma, F. M., Spoon, R., Henning, T., **Ngo, C. H.**, Camerer, C. F., & Smith, A. The Psychobiological Predictability of Experimental Asset Bubbles. [\[Poster\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)

**Ngo, C. H.** Feeding Attendance: The Impact of California's Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism. [\[Poster\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#)

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

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**Ngo, C. H.** & Camerer, C. F. Ultra-Processed Foods, Supernormalization, and Rational Inattention.

**Ngo, C. H.**, Manning, B. S., Avery, C. N., & Camerer, C. F. Large Language Models and Experimental Asset Bubbles.

Kang, Z., Weng, W., **Ngo, C. H.**, Wang, J. T., & Camerer, C. F. On the Biology of Rational Inattention.

**Ngo, C. H.** Why It Sounds Right: A Game-Theoretic and Statistical Learning Approach to Western Classical Music.

**Ngo, C. H.** The Impact of International Property Rights on Foreign Movie Exports: Evidence from Vietnam's WTO Accession.

## AWARDS & GRANTS

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### *External*

|                                                                             |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Midwest Economics Association's Best Undergraduate Paper, Honorable Mention | 2025      |
| Thomas and Charlotte Taylor Scholarship (\$10,000)                          | 2024–2025 |
| San Gabriel Women's Club Scholarship (\$4,000)                              | 2021–2025 |
| PREDOC.org Honorarium (\$500)                                               | 2024      |
| National Institute of Statistical Sciences IOF Travel Grant (\$450)         | 2023      |
| PREDOC.org Summer Research Award (\$2,000)                                  | 2023      |

### *Internal*

|                                                                    |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Gilbert DeBartolo '69 Memorial Prize in Economics (\$1,300)        | 2025      |
| Dean's Office Research Conference Travel Grant (\$1,920)           | 2025      |
| Professional Development Grant (\$1,700)                           | 2024–2025 |
| Founder's Scholarship (\$64,000)                                   | 2021–2025 |
| Grinnell Choice Scholarship (\$40,000)                             | 2021–2025 |
| Graduate School Scholarship (\$700)                                | 2024      |
| Summer Research Grant (\$4,000)                                    | 2024      |
| Externship Grant (\$960)                                           | 2023      |
| Hill Distinguished Award for Outstanding Music Performance (\$750) | 2023      |

## CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

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2026 West Coast Neuroeconomics Annual Symposium at UCLA (May 1)

- 2025 15th Annual Behavioral Science and Health Symposium at University of Pennsylvania  
*Lecture*: Ultra-Processed Foods, Supernormalization, and Rational Inattention
- PREDOC.org Research Conference at the World Bank in Washington, D.C.  
*Poster*: The Impact of California's Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism
- Midwest Economics Association 89th Annual Meeting in Kansas City, MO  
*Lecture\**: The Impact of California's Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism
- 2024 Research in Behavioral Finance Conference (RBFC) at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam  
*Lecture†*: The Psychobiological Predictability of Experimental Asset Bubbles
- Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop at Caltech  
*Poster*: The Market's Hidden Signals: Using Biometric Data to Predict Financial Bubbles
- SFP Summer Seminar Day at Caltech  
*Poster*: The Market's Hidden Signals: Using Biometric Data to Predict Financial Bubbles
- 2023 National Institute of Statistical Sciences Ingram Olkin Forum Series at Carleton College  
*Discussant*: Statistical Challenges in the Analysis of Police Use of Force
- Undergraduate Research Conference at the Federal Reserve Board of Governors in Washington, D.C.  
*Poster*: America's Interstate System as an Agent of Dampening Social Mobility
- PREDOC.org Seminar Series  
*Lecture*: America's Interstate System as an Agent of Dampening Social Mobility

†: *presented by co-author*

\*: *special recognition or award*

## SERVICE & TEACHING

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### *Service*

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| Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) Mentor, Caltech                              | 2026      |
| Board Member and Mentor, Diversity and Inclusion Club for Economics (DICE), Grinnell College | 2024–2025 |
| Elected Board Member, Student Educational Policy Committee for Economics, Grinnell College   | 2022–2025 |
| Advisory Board, PREDOC.org                                                                   | 2023–2025 |

### *Teaching*

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|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Course Tutor, Research Methods (PSY 225), Grinnell College | 2024–2025 |
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## CERTIFICATES & CERTIFICATIONS

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### *Certificates*

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Math for AI, Division of Engineering and Applied Sciences, Caltech                        | 2025 |
| Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems, Opportunity Insights and PREDOC.org | 2023 |

### *Certifications*

[CITI Biomedical Research](#)

[CITI Hybrid Research](#)

[CITI Social & Behavioral Research](#)

## OTHER EXPERIENCE

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### *Selective Doctoral Preview Programs*

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Doctoral Preview Day, Brown University                                                      | 2025 |
| Colorado Advantage Program, University of Colorado Boulder                                  | 2025 |
| Explore Michigan Engineering Research & Graduate Education (EMERGE), University of Michigan | 2025 |

### *Work Experience*

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|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Private English Tutor                                 | 2024–2025 |
| Private Mathematics Tutor                             | 2022–2025 |
| Grinnell House Attendant, Grinnell College            | 2023      |
| Mathematics Instructor, Mathnasium of Monterey Park   | 2022–2023 |
| Lead Mathematics Instructor, Mathnasium of San Marino | 2021–2023 |
| Director of Research and Board Member, Water Drop LA  | 2020–2022 |
| Secretary Assistant, Keck Medicine of USC             | 2019–2020 |

## SKILLS

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### *Programs*

Julia, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Python, R, Stata

### *Experiment Software*

Gorilla, oTree, Prolific, Qualtrics, WebGazer.js

### *Tools*

AWS, Cyberduck, Git, Google Workspace, Jupyter Notebooks, Microsoft Office Suite, Neurosynth, Overleaf, SPSS

### *Languages*

English (native), Vietnamese (intermediate), Cantonese (elementary)

## MISC

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### *Citizenship*

USA

Updated: February 4, 2026